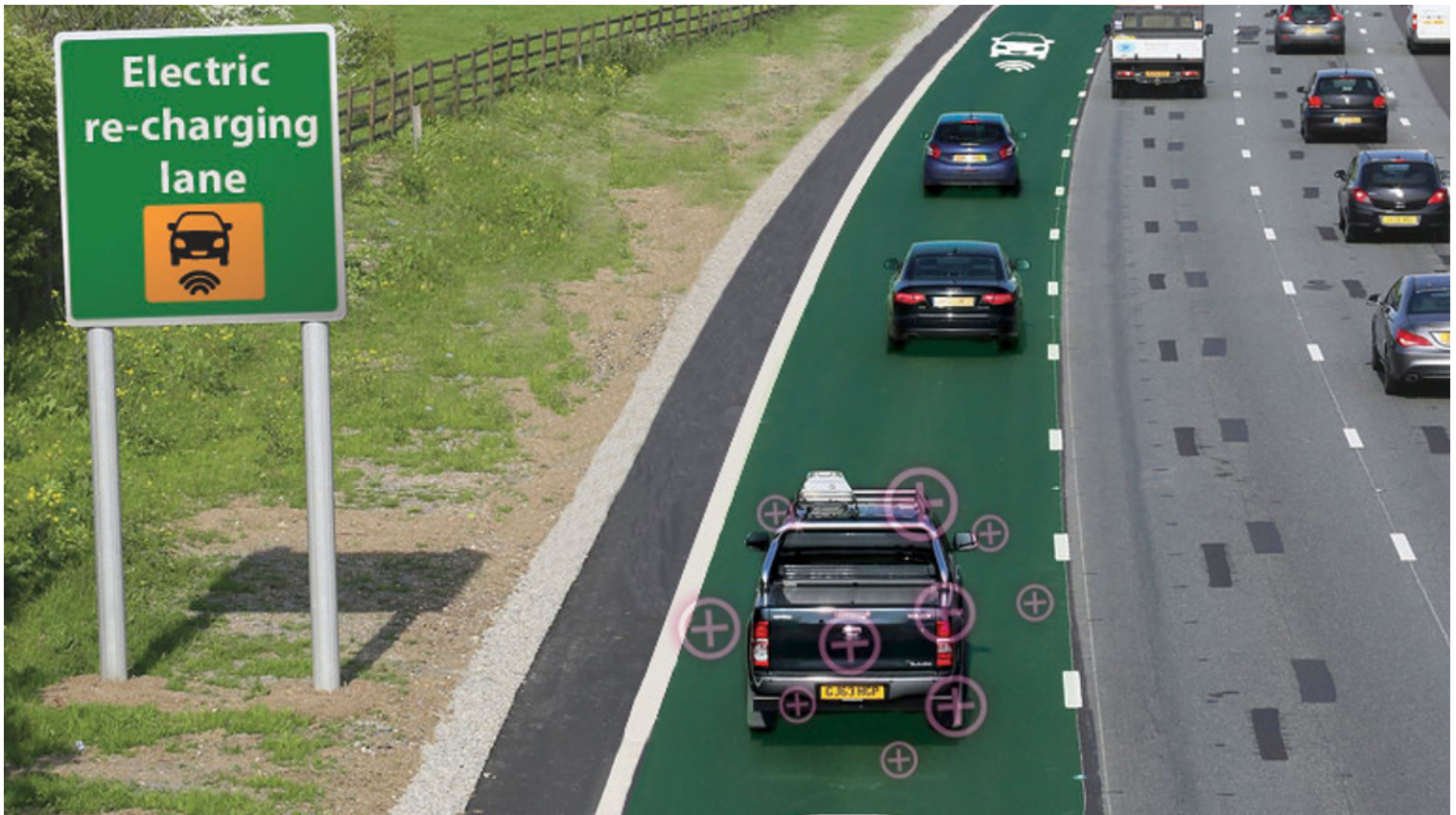


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Blog

Range Anxiety Be Gone! UK to Test Charging EVs in Transit

CHAZ WILKE ([HTTPS://SOLARMEHOME.COM/AUTHOR/CHAZW/](https://solarmehome.com/author/chazw/)) / AUGUST 31, 2015 ([HTTPS://SOLARMEHOME.COM/RANGE-ANXIETY-BE-GONE-UK-TO-TEST-CHARGING-EVS-IN-TRANSIT/](https://solarmehome.com/range-anxiety-be-gone-uk-to-test-charging-evs-in-transit/))
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A common reservation many have before buying an electric vehicle, or EV, is the fear of leaving the house with an insufficient charge that might leave the driver stranded far from home with an empty battery.

Since many currently available EVs have a range far less than their gas guzzling counterparts, the fear is not entirely without merit. General Motors even created (<http://aol.it/1fRsfwn>) a buzzword for the newfound fear: range anxiety.

Charge While You Drive

A recently announced project in the UK takes aim specifically at those that fear the vehicle's battery pack charge might not be sufficient to make a round trip. Highways England (<http://bit.ly/1O3LTBi>) is spearheading the proposed project and in the coming years, the company plans to create an 18-month trial of what it calls "charging lanes" as part of a feasibility study.

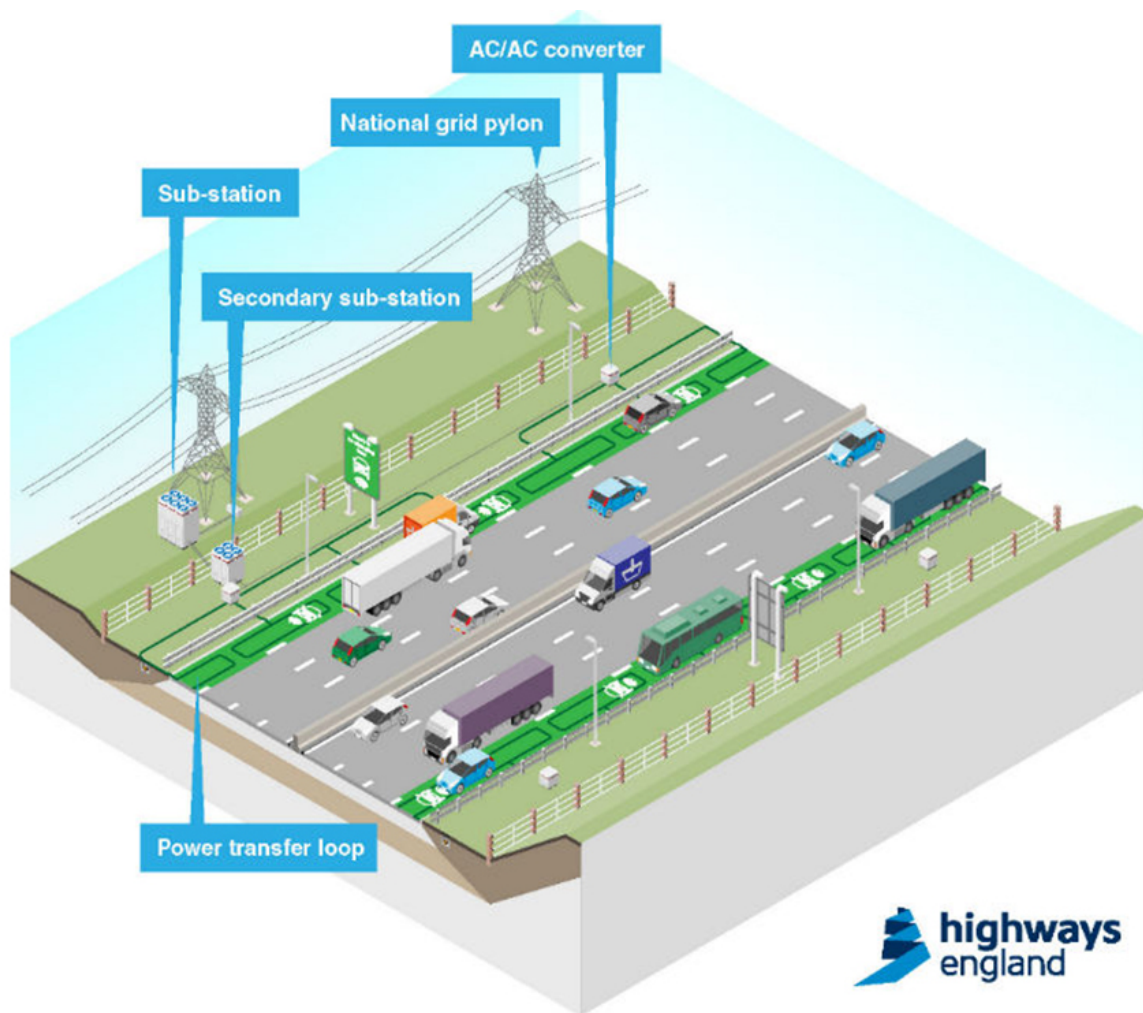
The initial trial will not be conducted on public roads. This will mitigate any initial hiccups in the technology and prevent any unforeseen issues with cars driven by the general public.

How It Works

Since the days of Edison and the advent of electricity, we've been accustomed to the telltale sign of a power cord running from the outlet to the electric gadget. This is no longer the case. New technologies are breaking the familiar bonds of transmitting electricity from one source to another.

Wireless power, once considered science fiction, is now a reality. Some cell phones already support wireless charging through a method called *inductive charging*. This involves placing the cell phone on a charging pad, and that direct contact is all that's necessary for the phone to receive a small electric current via an electromagnetic near field (<http://bit.ly/1X665ID>).

Intel is hard at work on this technology with the Alliance for Wireless Power. "Similar to how the Wi-Fi revolution in 2003 let people connect their mobile computers to the Internet without wires, new wireless charging technologies aim to free people from having to rely on their power cords at all," Intel says (<http://intel.ly/1PGZPSc>).



Tim Chester of Mashable reports (<http://on.mash.to/1O3MnHx>) that "during the trials, vehicles will be fitted with wireless technology and special equipment will be installed beneath roads to replicate motorway conditions." The electric cables under the road's surface will then generate the needed electromagnetic near fields. The cars used during this test will be outfitted with special inductive charging coils which can syphon off power from the near fields emitted by the roads.

Takeaway

These initial trials conducted by Highways England may soon prove a legitimate use of inductive charging while cruising down the highway. This application may finally ease the range anxiety of those waiting to buy an electric vehicle. “Vehicle technologies are advancing at an ever increasing pace and we’re committed to supporting the growth of ultra-low emissions vehicles on our England’s motorways,” says (<http://bit.ly/1O3LTBi>) Highways England chief highways engineer Mike Wilson.

This ambitious plan is not without its detractors. Some question the need for such a large infrastructure overhaul considering the constantly improving battery technologies. Just recently a duo in Denmark logged an incredible maximum range of 452.8 miles (<http://bit.ly/1EvUXis>) on a single charge in a Tesla Model S P85D. That kind of range is not the norm, but it might just be a hint of our range-anxiety-free future!

Top Image Credit: Highways England

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